

Saturday, 10 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

15° 11°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

13° 10°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

13° 10°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

12° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Ofsted is facing renewed calls to halt graded school inspections in England.

A second head teachers' union has expressed increasing concern about the welfare and morale of its members. This follows ongoing debate about the impact of the current inspection system.

EDUCATION · UK

2

The King has reportedly paid Prince Andrew's £1.5 million repair bill for Royal Lodge.

The Duke of York was charged for restoration costs after surrendering the lease on the 30-room mansion. This comes amidst ongoing discussions about royal finances.

ROYAL · UK

3

Police say a woman found dead in a burning van in Rhyl was pregnant.

A court has been told that Samantha Phythian was alive when the fire started. Investigations into the tragic incident are continuing.

CRIME · UK

4

The leader of the Green Party, Polanski, is vowing to stay on despite criticism after a by-election defeat.

He faces calls to resign from the Jewish Greens' leader following a row over Zionism. The party is now assessing its next steps.

POLITICS · UK

5

A major review into autism, ADHD, and mental health has revealed significant lessons for public policy.

The findings contain important takeaways for the NHS, welfare, education, and employment policies. Experts are now analysing the implications.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The hit film 'Crazy Rich Asians' is set to return as a TV show, featuring the original cast members.**
The new series will pick up where the 2018 movie left off, with Constance Wu, Henry Golding, and Michelle Yeoh expected to star. Fans are eagerly anticipating its return.
| ON AIR – Are you excited for the return of 'Crazy Rich Asians'? What makes it such a popular story?
TV · COMING SOON
- 2 The popular video game 'Cyberpunk 2077' is getting a live-action movie adaptation.**
Paramount Pictures will be bringing the smash hit from the studio behind 'The Witcher' series to the big screen. This is big news for gamers and film fans alike.
| ON AIR – Which video game do you think would make the best movie adaptation, and why?
FILM · COMING SOON
- 3 Hollywood actor Luke Evans has described his 'joyous' four months filming in rainy Wales.**
His family visited the set, and he even managed to get some relatives a cameo in the final episode. He clearly loved his time back home.
| ON AIR – If you could get a cameo in any TV show or film, which would you pick?
TV · COMING SOON
- 4 The 'bold and inventive' Canadian poet Anne Carson has been awarded the Nobel Literature Prize.**
Carson, 76, is celebrated for her works that often cross boundaries between poetry, fiction, and scholarship. It's a huge honour for the acclaimed writer.
| ON AIR – What's the last book that really captivated you, and why?
AWARDS · THIS WEEK
- 5 A new Black and African cinema hub, EbonyLife Place London, has officially opened its doors.**
It's the brainchild of Nollywood media mogul Mo Abudu, aiming to provide a dedicated space for diverse storytelling. This is a fantastic addition to London's cultural scene.
| ON AIR – What kind of films or shows are you hoping to see more of in the future?
FILM · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

- 1 All eyes will be on Anfield this Sunday as Manchester City head to Liverpool.**
It's their first game since being found guilty of breaching Premier League rules, so expect quite a reception. The atmosphere is sure to be electric.
ON AIR – What kind of reception do you think Manchester City will get from the Liverpool fans?
FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Tickets for Tyson Fury and Anthony Joshua's highly anticipated fight sold out in just one hour.**
Priced up to £13,000, the tickets for the Cardiff Principality Stadium bout show the massive demand for this heavyweight clash. It's set to be a huge event.
ON AIR – Were you one of the lucky ones to get a ticket for Fury vs. Joshua, or will you be watching from home?
BOXING · UK
- 3 Everton are reportedly up for sale again, with owners TFG looking for a way out.**
This news raises questions about what's next for the club as they search for new ownership. It's a turbulent time for the Merseyside team.
ON AIR – What do you think is the biggest challenge facing Everton right now?
FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Max Verstappen has secured sprint pole position at the Singapore Grand Prix, despite another settings issue.**
The Red Bull driver beat Mercedes' George Russell to the top spot. It sets up an exciting race weekend in Singapore.
ON AIR – Who are you backing to win the Singapore Grand Prix this weekend?
F1 · INTERNATIONAL
- 5 Shaun Edwards has joined Argentina's coaching staff as their new defence coach.**
His deal runs until the end of the 2027 Rugby World Cup in Australia. This is a significant move for the Pumas.
ON AIR – How much impact do you think a new defence coach can have on a rugby team?
RUGBY · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 The surprising joy of perfectly peeling a satsuma in one go is gaining recognition.**
Many people find a unique, satisfying little thrill in managing to remove a satsuma's peel entirely intact. It's a small victory in a busy day.
- 2 A new appreciation is emerging for the comforting sight of 'a full biscuit tin'.**
Having a tin generously stocked with an assortment of biscuits is being celebrated as a simple pleasure, symbolising readiness for a tea break or unexpected guests.
- 3 The quiet delight of finding a forgotten five-pound note in an old coat pocket is being championed.**
This unexpected little bonus, often discovered when changing seasons or clearing out, is a delightful surprise that brightens the day.
- 4 Experts are highlighting the calming effect of watching a proper British drizzle.**
There's a gentle, almost meditative quality to observing light rain outside, providing a cosy backdrop for indoor activities without the drama of a downpour.
- 5 The unique satisfaction of successfully navigating a 'flat-pack furniture' project without a single argument is becoming a celebrated achievement.**
It's a test of patience and teamwork, and getting to the end with all screws in place and relationships intact is truly something to cheer about.
- 6 There's a growing trend towards appreciating the nostalgic clinking sound of 'milk bottles on the doorstep' in the morning.**
For many, it's a comforting auditory reminder of traditional mornings and a simpler time, bringing a sense of warmth and community.
- 7 The subtle art of 'waving goodbye to someone until they are completely out of sight' is gaining recognition as a thoughtful gesture.**
It's a small, kind act that many of us instinctively do, showing a sweet moment of connection and reassurance.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?

ANSWER: LOOKING UP THE COCOA PERCENTAGE AND ORIGIN STORY ON THE WRAPPER!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: TAKING A REALLY BIG SNIFF OF IT, EVEN IF THE CAP IS SEALED!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you just have 'one particular cupboard or drawer' in your home that, no matter how many times you tidy it, always seems to descend into delightful chaos?

Is there a specific 'chaos cupboard' or 'mystery drawer' in your house that you've just given up trying to keep neat, and what sort of wonderful jumble does it usually contain?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday sound' that, despite its simplicity, genuinely makes us feel happy or brings a little bit of comfort, don't we?

What's that one unexpected everyday sound that always brings a little smile to your face, whether it's the purr of a cat, the kettle boiling, or maybe even the bin lorries on a Tuesday morning?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat? Their diet includes brine shrimp and algae, which contain pigments called carotenoids.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called an 'array'? They often gather in groups in British gardens during autumn.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The official residence of the British monarch in London, Buckingham Palace, has 775 rooms.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Lemons contain more sugar than strawberries.
- The first recorded game of golf was played at Bruntsfield Links, Edinburgh, in 1456.
- There are more than 10,000 different varieties of tomatoes.
- Big Ben is actually the nickname for the Great Bell of the clock at the north end of the Palace of Westminster, not the clock tower itself.
- The King James Bible, published in 1611, includes a printer's error in Ruth 3:15, which famously reads 'He went into the city' instead of 'She went into the city'.
- A jiffy is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.

On this day

Day 283 of the year, 82 days left in 2026. Today Aleksis Kivi Day, also known as the Finnish Literature Day (Finland); Arbor Day (Poland); Army Day (Sri Lanka); Capital Liberation Day (Vietnam). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1953 — Midge Ure, Scottish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1969 — Wendi McLendon-Covey, American actress
- 1989 — Emer Kenny, English actress and screenwriter
- 1946 — Anne Mather, English author and screenwriter
- 1970 — Matthew Pinsent, English rower and sportscaster
- 1965 — Chris Penn, American actor (died 2006)
- 1981 — Laura Tobin, English weather reporter
- 1961 — Martin Kemp, English singer-songwriter and bass player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1971 — Aeroflot Flight 773 is destroyed by a bomb over Moscow Oblast, killing 25.
- 1963 — France cedes control of the Bizerte naval base to Tunisia.
- 1997 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 2553 crashes and explodes in Uruguay, killing 74.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1997 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 2553 crashes and explodes in Uruguay, killing 74.
- 2022 — Ben S. Bernanke, Douglas W. Diamond and Philip H. Dybvig are jointly awarded the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2015 — Twin bomb blasts in the Turkish capital Ankara kill 109 and injure 500+.
- 1985 — US Navy aircraft intercept an Egyptian airliner carrying the perpetrators of the Achille Lauro hijacking, and force it to land in Italy.
- 1970 — Fiji becomes independent.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 284 of the year, 81 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Agilbert; Christian feast days: Alexander Sauli; Christian feast days: Andronicus, Probus, and Tarachus (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast days: Æthelburh of Barking. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Dawn French, Welsh-English actress, comedian and screenwriter
- 1976 — Emily Deschanel, American actress and producer
- 1962 — Joan Cusack, American actress
- 1944 — Rodney Marsh, English footballer, manager, and sportscaster
- 1932 — Dottie West, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 1991)
- 1968 — Jane Krakowski, American actress and singer
- 1956 — Stephen Spinella, American actor
- 1971 — Petra Haden, American violinist and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1941 — Beginning of the National Liberation War of Macedonia.
- 1987 — The AIDS Memorial Quilt is first displayed during the Second National March on Washington for Lesbian and Gay Rights.
- 2018 — Soyuz MS-10, launching an intended crew for the ISS, suffers an in-flight abort. The crew lands safely.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1142 — A peace treaty ends the Jin–Song wars.
- 1942 — World War II: Off Guadalcanal, United States Navy ships intercept and defeat a Japanese force.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar